“Let’s give her a Russian name, to honor her mother.”

“Back in Orléans, there was a girl in school I sometimes played with; her father was Russian.”

“What was her name?”

“Katya.”

“That’s a beautiful name.” Léa smiled sadly. “I promised Nadiya to keep her child, and I will honor that. If I don’t adopt her, she’ll be sent to the Children’s Home for Foreign Workers.” Léa sighed. “Nadiya once told me that in her language, her name means hope. Now, we have to offer Katya the hope her mother isn’t here to give.”

Rose stepped closer, and Léa took Katya, cradling her in her arms. Katya cried. Léa tried to console this new life, even though the future felt more uncertain than ever.